

Species cards — review sheet

Colour, A6 double-sided, one deck per following page (8 cards, grouped by workshop table for printing only). Front is identification: photo, name, scientific name, one-line description, verified size and where it lives. Back is the food web: what it eats and what eats it, as sourced bullets, plus a QR to that species' own guide page.

For review. The print artwork is the separate 4-up A6 file. Every photo is a real, print-safe (CC0 / CC-BY / CC-BY-SA) image showing the live animal in water or on natural substrate — none hand-held or out of habitat — each checked with Gemini vision for whole-body visibility (see the build log for scores). Size and diet are mirrored from the verified species-guide data (PR #152): each diet bullet was read from a published account, and the card shows as many as fit, with the full list one QR scan away.



Common Limpet

Patella vulgata

SIZE

Shell up to 6 cm long, 5 cm wide and 3 cm high

LIVES

Rocky crevices

BEHAVIOUR

Creeps over the rock grazing algae when the tide is in or the shore is damp,...

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Painted Top Shell

Calliostoma zizyphinum

SIZE

Shell up to 3 cm (30 mm) high and 3 cm broad

LIVES

Rocky crevices and the seaweed canopy

BEHAVIOUR

Wipes mucus over its own shell twice every 24 hours and eats the...

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Two-spotted goby

Gobiusculus flavescens

SIZE

Up to 6 cm total length

LIVES

The seaweed canopy and open midwater

BEHAVIOUR

Hovers in small, loose shoals in the water column instead of resting on the...

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Thick-lipped mullet

Chelon labrosus

SIZE

Up to 70-75 cm, commonly around 32 cm

LIVES

Near the surface and the open sand

BEHAVIOUR

Adults school inshore, occasionally moving northward in summer as temperatures...

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Common Limpet

I EAT

- A wide range of micro-organisms and algae, grazed straight off the rock
- Wrack germlings and other young seaweed sporelings, cropped before they can establish

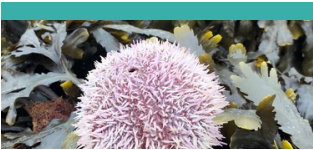
EATS ME

- Oystercatchers, which take limpets from rocky shores and feed them to their chicks
- Crabs, taking limpets that have been knocked off or have lost their grip on the rock



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Edible sea urchin

Echinus esculentus

SIZE

Up to 15 to 16 cm in diameter, largest recorded 17.6 cm

LIVES

Rocky crevices and the seaweed canopy

BEHAVIOUR

A solitary, creeping omnivore that grazes and scavenges over the rock

(c) Ron Pasieczna, some rights reserved (CC BY) · CC-BY · via manual



Ballan wrasse

Labrus bergylla

SIZE

Up to 65.9 cm long, commonly 30-50 cm

LIVES

Rocky crevices and the seaweed canopy

BEHAVIOUR

Active by day, hiding in rock crevices and seaweed at night

(c) Jayre, some rights reserved (CC BY) · CC-BY · via inaturalist



Spider Crab

Majoidea

SIZE

Body up to 20 cm long; carapace to 200 mm in males and 175 mm in females

LIVES

The seaweed canopy and rocky crevices and the open sand

BEHAVIOUR

A seabed scavenger whose shell is usually covered with algae

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Great cormorant

Phalacrocorax carbo

SIZE

Length 80-100 cm, wingspan 121-160 cm, weight 2-3.7 kg

LIVES

Coastal cliffs and rocky shores, diving inshore to hunt

BEHAVIOUR

Sociable; nests in colonies and often hunts in groups, then perches with its...

Alexis Lours, CC BY 2.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY · via wikimedia



Edible sea urchin

I EAT

- Seaweeds grazed off the rock, with kelps such as Laminaria a preferred food
- Encrusting animals scraped off the rock, including barnacles, hydroids, bryozoans and sea squirts

EATS ME

- European lobsters, which may prey on it
- Wolf-fish, which may take it in the north
- European shags, whose diet samples at a northern UK roost held this urchin in 27% of samples



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Ballan wrasse

I EAT

- Crabs and other decapod crustaceans, a major prey group in Irish, Breton and Azorean gut studies

EATS ME

- Grey seals, whose scats around Scotland yield ballan wrasse otoliths
- Cormorants, which at sea feed mainly on bottom-dwelling fish, wrasses and codfishes over rocky, weed-covered ground



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Spider Crab

I EAT

- A scavenger on most seabed types, taking carrion, encrusting animals and seaweed
- Juveniles forage on algal-invertebrate turf in shallow nursery grounds through their first two years

EATS ME

- Atlantic cod, which take spider crabs among their bottom-living crustacean prey
- Small-spotted catshark, recorded taking the great spider crab off England and Wales



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Great cormorant

I EAT

- Almost entirely fish, mostly under 20 cm long, occasionally up to 75 cm
- At sea mainly bottom-living fish: wrasses and codfishes over rock and weed, flatfish over soft ground

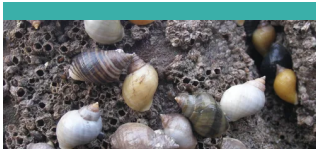
EATS ME

- Gulls and crows take eggs and chicks at nesting colonies, mostly where a colony has been disturbed
- Fledglings are taken by eagles, including white-tailed eagle, and by red foxes



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Dog Whelk

Nucella lapillus

SIZE

Shell usually up to 3 cm high and 2 cm broad, reaching 6 cm in a few exceptional...

LIVES

Rocky crevices

BEHAVIOUR

A slow-creeping predator, most active at night and rarely moving far

Martin Talbot, CC BY 2.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY · via wikimedia



Dog Whelk

I EAT

- Mainly barnacles and mussels, the sessile animals that hold space on a rocky shore
- Cockles, other bivalves and other sea snails, taken less often

EATS ME

- Gulls and eider ducks swallow adults whole, and oystercatchers have caused heavy winter mortality; whelks of 4 cm or more are probably safe from birds



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.



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Velvet Swimming Crab

Necora puber

SIZE

Carapace up to about 8 cm across; males 78-96 mm wide, females 68-92 mm

LIVES

Rocky crevices and the seaweed canopy

BEHAVIOUR

Fast-moving and unusually aggressive, often meeting a diver head-on in a...

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Velvet Swimming Crab

I EAT

- Brown algae, which makes up much of the diet in shallow water, with the animal share of it rising with depth

EATS ME

- Seabirds such as the European shag, for which this was the most frequent prey at a Shetland roost through the non-breeding season
- Fish, including adult sea bass, which take it on the continental shelf



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.



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Spiny Starfish

Marthasterias glacialis

SIZE

Up to 70 cm across, commonly 25-30 cm

LIVES

Rocky crevices and the open sand

BEHAVIOUR

A slow-moving predator that finds prey by chemoreception and chance encounter,...

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Spiny Starfish

I EAT

- Mussels above all: the most-taken prey item at every depth on shallow rocky reefs, and preferred over urchins and snails in feeding trials

EATS ME

- Other starfish: the seven-armed starfish and the sunstars are recorded predators, and the common starfish also takes it as prey



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.



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Common Starfish

Asterias rubens

SIZE

Up to 52 cm in diameter, commonly 10-30 cm

LIVES

The open sand and rocky crevices

BEHAVIOUR

A slow-crawling seabed predator and scavenger, usually solitary but sometimes...

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Common Starfish

I EAT

- Bivalve molluscs, prised open with the tube feet and digested by turning the stomach out into the shell
- Polychaete worms, other echinoderms and the occasional small crustacean, all taken alive

EATS ME

- The common sun star, a predatory starfish this animal turns and moves away from when it detects one
- Young Atlantic cod, recorded taking Asterias starfish among their seabed prey off Scotland



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.



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Common Brittlestar

Ophiothrix fragilis

SIZE

Disk up to 2 cm across, with five arms about five times the disk diameter

LIVES

Rocky crevices and the open sand

BEHAVIOUR

Gregarious passive suspension feeder, arms held up into the current

(c) Lou Wagstaffe, some rights reserved (CC BY) · CC-BY · via inaturalist



Common Brittlestar

I EAT

- Phytoplankton, diatoms and fine detritus taken from the water
- Suspended particles strained from the current with the arms held up into the water

EATS ME

- Bottom-feeding fish, including ballan and cuckoo wrasse, dragonets, cod and plaice
- Crabs, especially swimming crabs such as the velvet crab



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.



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Shore Crab

Carcinus maenas

SIZE

Shell (carapace) commonly 4-8 cm wide, with males recorded to 86 mm across

LIVES

Rocky crevices and the open sand

BEHAVIOUR

Walks over the bottom as an omnivorous predator and scavenger

Jürgen Hamann, CC BY-SA 4.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY-SA · via wikimedia



Shore Crab

I EAT

- A true omnivore, taking molluscs, other crustaceans, worms, algae and carrion
- Large crabs feed mainly on molluscs, with the common mussel the single most important prey

EATS ME

- Mainly fish and birds, including gulls, cormorants and eider ducks, and otters in some areas
- Atlantic cod, which take shore crabs among their bottom-living crustacean prey



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.



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Edible Crab

Cancer pagurus

SIZE

Carapace width up to 25 cm, typically up to 15 cm

LIVES

Rocky crevices and the open sand

BEHAVIOUR

Mainly nocturnal; ambushes prey from shelters under rocks and digs large pits...

Olivier Dugornay (tlfremer), CC BY 4.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY · via wikimedia



Edible Crab

I EAT

- A variety of live molluscs and crustaceans, as well as carrion
- Crustaceans such as shore crabs, porcelain crabs and squat lobsters, and smaller crabs of its own kind

EATS ME

- Fish such as cod and wolffish, which it is thought to avoid by being mainly nocturnal
- Seals, which take crabs and hunt by sight
- Conger eels, recorded taking edible crabs off Ireland



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.



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Common eider

Somateria mollissima

SIZE

Length 55-60 cm, wingspan 94 cm, weight about 2.2 kg; the UK's heaviest duck

LIVES

Sheltered rocky coasts, diving for mussels

BEHAVIOUR

Very sociable, riding the swell close to shore in flocks up to several hundred...

Andreas Trepte, CC BY-SA 2.5 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY-SA · via wikimedia



Common eider

I EAT

- Blue mussels and other bivalve molluscs, taken on dives
- Crabs and other crustaceans
- Echinoderms, with some aquatic insects and small fish

EATS ME

- Great skuas (bonxies), which take adult females at and near the nest
- Large gulls and great skuas (bonxies), which take many young chicks



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.



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Sprat

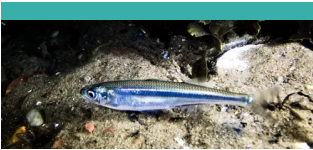
Sprattus sprattus

SIZE
Up to 16 to 25.1 cm, commonly about 12 cm

LIVES
Open midwater and the open water

BEHAVIOUR
Schools inshore, rising to the surface at night, and migrates between winter...

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Sand smelt

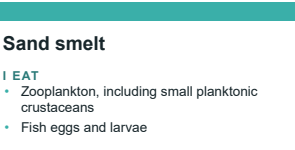
Atherina presbyter

SIZE
Up to 20 cm, usually 12 to 16 cm

LIVES
Near the surface and the open sand

BEHAVIOUR
Schools near the surface and makes seasonal migrations along Atlantic coasts

(c) Klaus Kevin Kristensen, some rights reserved (CC BY) · CC-BY · via manual



Sand smelt

I EAT

- Zooplankton, including small planktonic crustaceans
- Fish eggs and larvae

EATS ME

- Great cormorants, for which sand smelt is an important estuarine prey in southern Europe

BEHAVIOUR
Schools near the surface and makes seasonal migrations along Atlantic coasts

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Fifteen-spined stickleback

Spinachia spinachia

SIZE
Up to 25 cm long, with a maximum recorded standard length of 22 cm

LIVES
The seaweed canopy

BEHAVIOUR
Lives singly or in pairs; the male builds a nest of algal fragments glued with...

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Poor cod

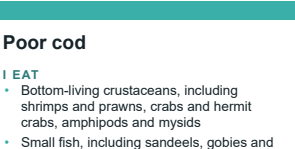
Trisopterus minutus

SIZE
Commonly about 20 cm total length, with reported maxima of 26 to 40 cm

LIVES
Open midwater and rocky crevices

BEHAVIOUR
Gregarious, living in small schools; a demersal predator and scavenger that...

Julien Renoult, CC BY 4.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY · via wikimedia



Poor cod

I EAT

- Bottom-living crustaceans, including shrimps and prawns, crabs and hermit crabs, amphipods and mysids
- Small fish, including sandeels, gobies and dragonets
- Polychaete worms taken off the seabed

EATS ME

- Larger predatory fish such as cod, whiting, hake and turbot
- Grey and harbour seals, which commonly take poor cod in Scottish waters
- Conger eel and anglerfish

BEHAVIOUR
Gregarious, living in small schools; a demersal predator and scavenger that...

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Bib

Trisopterus luscus

SIZE
Up to 46 cm total length, commonly around 30 cm; adults usually 20-30 cm

LIVES
Rocky crevices and open midwater

BEHAVIOUR
Gregarious; young fish often in large schools, and moves inshore to 50 m or...

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Pollack

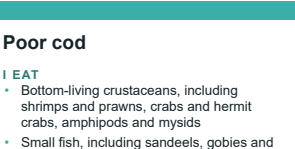
Pollachius pollachius

SIZE
Up to 130 cm total length, commonly about 75 cm

LIVES
Open midwater and the seaweed canopy and rocky crevices

BEHAVIOUR
Hangs above kelp forests and wrecks singly or in small shoals, darting up from...

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Pollack

I EAT

- Open-water shoaling fish: sandeels, herring, sprat and capelin
- Deep-sea prawns and shrimps; juveniles feed mainly on crustaceans among inshore rocks and weed

EATS ME

- Seals, which take pollack from gillnets and tangle nets; one study estimated 18% of pollack landings were depredated

BEHAVIOUR
Hangs above kelp forests and wrecks singly or in small shoals, darting up from...

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Atlantic cod

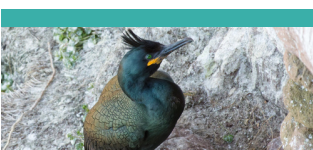
Gadus morhua

SIZE
Up to 200 cm total length, commonly around 100 cm

LIVES
Open midwater and the open sand

BEHAVIOUR
Schools by day about 30-80 m above the bottom, dispersing at night to feed

Hans-Petter Fjeld, CC BY-SA 2.5 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY-SA · via wikimedia



European shag

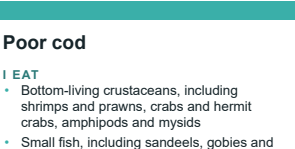
Phalacrocorax aristotelis

SIZE
Up to about 80 cm long, wingspan 90-105 cm, weight about 1.75-2.25 kg

LIVES
Sea cliffs and rocky ledges, diving close inshore

BEHAVIOUR
Leaps clear of the surface into a pursuit dive and feeds at the seabed

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European shag

I EAT

- Almost exclusively small fish, caught by diving and pursuing them underwater; sandeels dominate in many populations, with gadoids such as saithe more important further north

EATS ME

- Introduced American mink, which reach the birds at some nesting colonies

BEHAVIOUR
Leaps clear of the surface into a pursuit dive and feeds at the seabed

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Hermit Crab

Pagurus bernhardus

SIZE
Carapace up to 35 mm long, the whole animal up to 4 cm, often looking larger because of...

LIVES
The open sand and rocky crevices

BEHAVIOUR
Crawls about on the seabed on its own, carrying an empty snail shell, sometimes...

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Shanny

Lipophrys pholis

SIZE
Up to 16-17 cm total length, and up to 10 years old

LIVES
Rocky crevices

BEHAVIOUR
Resident with homing behaviour; forages at high tide and can stay out of water...

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Common Octopus

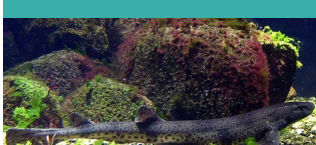
Octopus vulgaris

SIZE
Total length to 1.3-1.8 m; mantle length to 40 cm, commonly around 25 cm

LIVES
Rocky crevices and the open sand

BEHAVIOUR
Mainly night active, spending daylight hours in a den in a rock crevice or dug...

albert kok, CC BY-SA 3.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY-SA · via wikimedia



Lesser-spotted catshark

Scyliorhinus canicula

SIZE
Up to about 75 cm, commonly around 60 cm; a 100 cm record may be a misidentification of a...

LIVES
The open sand and rocky crevices

BEHAVIOUR
Nocturnal: by day males rest on the seabed and females hide in shallow caves...

Ernstia, CC BY-SA 2.5 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY-SA · via wikimedia



Hermit Crab

I EAT

- An omnivorous scavenger, taking organic detritus and carrion off the seabed
- Sifts the sediment surface as a deposit feeder, and can also strain suspended particles from the water

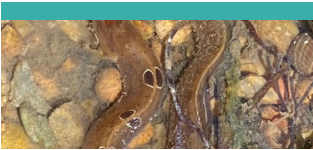
EATS ME

- Bottom-feeding fish of the cod family, including cod, whiting and pouting
- Gurnards and the lesser-spotted catshark, which hunt over the open seabed



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Butterfish

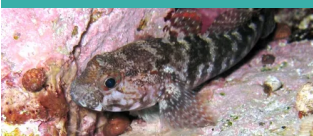
Pholis gunnellus

SIZE
Up to 25 cm long

LIVES
Rocky crevices and the open sand

BEHAVIOUR
Shelters under rocks and seaweed and breathes air when out of water

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Rock goby

Gobius paganellus

SIZE
Up to 12 to 13 cm, mature at about 6 to 7 cm

LIVES
Rocky crevices

BEHAVIOUR
Sedentary bottom-dweller; hides under stones and freezes rather than fleeing...

Roberto Pilon, CC BY 3.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY · via wikimedia



Conger eel

Conger conger

SIZE
Up to 275-300 cm total length and 110 kg, commonly 100-200 cm

LIVES
Rocky crevices

BEHAVIOUR
Rests in its hole by day and hunts at night

Holger Krisp, CC BY 3.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY · via wikimedia



Grey seal

Halichoerus grypus

SIZE
Adults up to about 2.3 m long; males over 300 kg, females around 150-200 kg

LIVES
Rocky shores and skerries, hauled out between dives

BEHAVIOUR
Ranges widely to forage, often over 100 km between haul-out sites, on trips of...

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Butterfish

I EAT

- Small crustaceans
- Polychaete worms
- Molluscs and fish eggs

EATS ME

- European shag, which takes gunnels at a North Sea colony, where they occurred in 8% of diet samples
- Atlantic cod, with recruit and juvenile fish recorded eating rock gunnels in Scottish waters



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Rock goby

I EAT

- Crustaceans, especially larger amphipods, isopods and small crabs
- Polychaete worms and other macrobenthos gleaned from hard substrates

EATS ME

- Common cuttlefish, which feeds on gobies, sandeels, whiting and wrasses
- The lizardfish Synodus saurus, recorded preying on this species in the Azores



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Conger eel

I EAT

- Bony fish taken at night, from whiting, poor cod and dragonet to flatfish such as plaice and dab

EATS ME

- Grey seals, whose scats in Scottish waters contain conger eel otoliths
- Common octopus, which is recorded with conger eel among its prey



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Grey seal

I EAT

- Sandeels, typically the predominant prey species
- Gadoids, including cod, whiting, haddock and ling
- Flatfish such as plaice, sole, flounder and dab, and cephalopods

EATS ME

- A few specialist adult male grey seals, which kill and eat pups and juveniles
- Killer whales; their predation may be linked to the predicted decline in pup production in Shetland



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Sea potato

Echinocardium cordatum

SIZE

Up to 9 cm long, usually about 4 to 6 cm

LIVES

The open sand

BEHAVIOUR

Lives buried in a permanent mucus-lined burrow with a breathing shaft to the...

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Dragonet

Callionymus lyra

SIZE

Up to 30.5 cm total length (females to 25 cm), commonly about 15 cm

LIVES

The open sand

BEHAVIOUR

Territorial, males aggressive with each other

Diego Delso, CC BY-SA 4.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY-SA · via wikipedia



Long-spined sea scorpion

Taurulus bubalis

SIZE

Up to 25 cm (females) and 17.5 cm (males), commonly about 12 cm

LIVES

Rocky crevices and the seaweed canopy

BEHAVIOUR

A resident ambush predator that lies motionless, relying on camouflage

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Flounder

Platichthys flesus

SIZE

Up to 60 cm, commonly around 50 cm

LIVES

The open sand

BEHAVIOUR

Burrows into the bottom; moves up into the intertidal with the incoming tide...

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Sea potato

I EAT

- Detritus, the dead organic matter mixed through the sand it lives in
- Sediment particles taken indiscriminately, both from the surface and from well below it

EATS ME

- Plaice, which take it among the soft-sediment prey they pick off sandy ground
- Gulls, which take the shallowest-burrowed animals when extreme low spring tides put them within reach



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Purple heart urchin

Spatangus purpureus

SIZE

Up to 12 cm long and 8 cm across

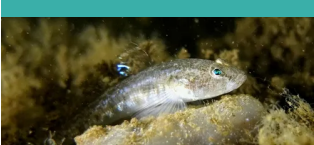
LIVES

The open sand

BEHAVIOUR

Burrows and crawls beneath the sediment, leaving furrows in the gravel where it...

Rpillon, CC BY-SA 3.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY-SA · via wikipedia



Sand goby

Pomatoschistus minutus

SIZE

Up to 10-11 cm long, mature from about 4-6 cm

LIVES

The open sand

BEHAVIOUR

Usually inactive except when feeding, mainly by day

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Purple heart urchin

I EAT

- Organic detritus, taken both from the surface of the sediment and from within it
- Spatangid heart urchins feed omnivorously on phytodetritus, faunal detritus and bacterial mats

EATS ME

- The large comb star *Astropecten aranciacus*, its principal predator



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

pebl-cic.co.uk

Sand goby

I EAT

- Small bottom-living crustaceans, chiefly amphipods, mysids and cumaceans
- Small polychaete worms taken from the sand and mud
- Fish eggs and larvae, including the young of its own species

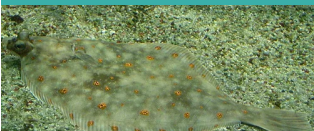
EATS ME

- Gadoid fish, especially cod and whiting
- Flatfish, including plaice and flounder
- Fish-eating birds and marine mammals, including harbour seal and harbour porpoise



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Plaice

Pleuronectes platessa

SIZE

Up to 100 cm, though 50-60 cm is the usual limit and exceptional fish reach 90 cm

LIVES

The open sand

BEHAVIOUR

Lies quietly on the bottom for long periods, often partly buried in sand, and...

NasserHalaweh, CC BY-SA 4.0 via Wikimedia Commons · CC-BY-SA · via wikipedia



Plaice

I EAT

- Bottom-living shellfish, particularly cockles and razor shells, and thin-shelled molluscs generally; young fish take bivalve siphon tips protruding from the seabed

EATS ME

- Grey seals, for which plaice is a significant part of the diet, and other marine mammals including harbour seal and harbour porpoise



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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Harbour seal

Phoca vitulina

SIZE

1.2 to 2 m long and 65 to 140 kg, adults typically 80 to 100 kg

LIVES

Sandbanks and sheltered shores, hauled out between dives

BEHAVIOUR

Hauls out on land on a pattern tied to the tide

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Harbour seal

I EAT

- A wide range of fish: sandeels, gadoids, herring and sprat, and flatfish, with the mix varying by season and region
- Cephalopods: octopus and squid

EATS ME

- Grey seals, whose adult males prey on adult harbour seals, most of all during the breeding season
- Sharks, killer whales and polar bears



Scan for more. Depth, behaviour, the full diet, and every source.

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